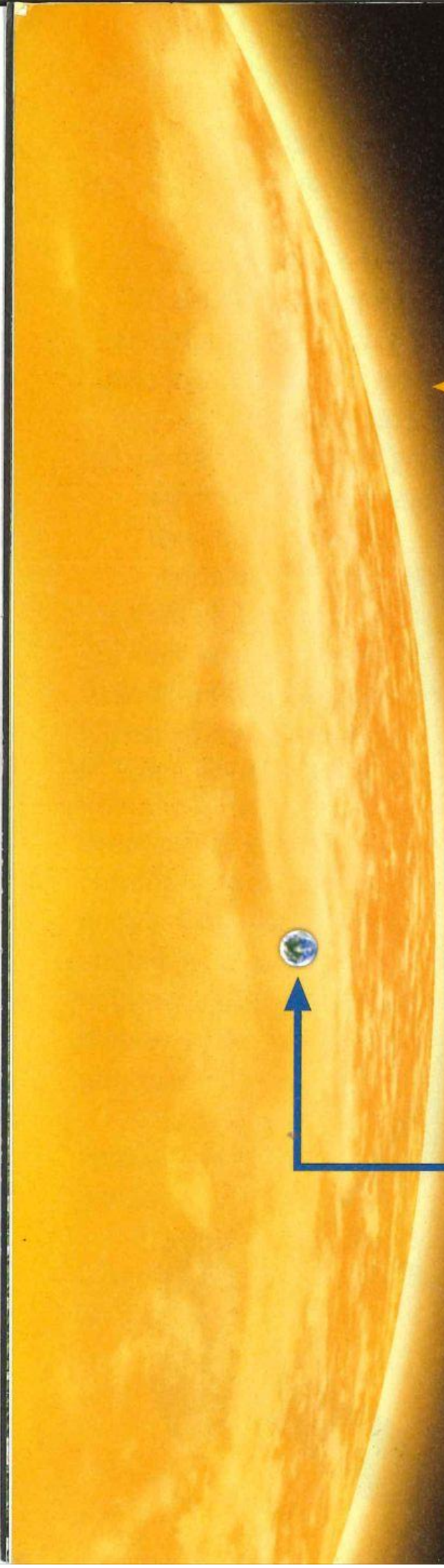




SUN

by Rhonda Moselen

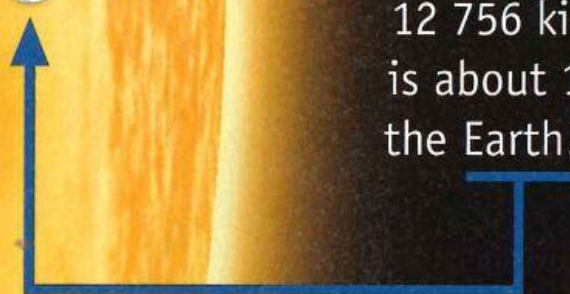


The Sun is a medium-sized star.

The temperature of the Sun's surface is 6000°C . The Sun is even hotter at its centre, where the temperature is at least 14 million degrees Celsius!

A very hot day in New Zealand is about 30°C .

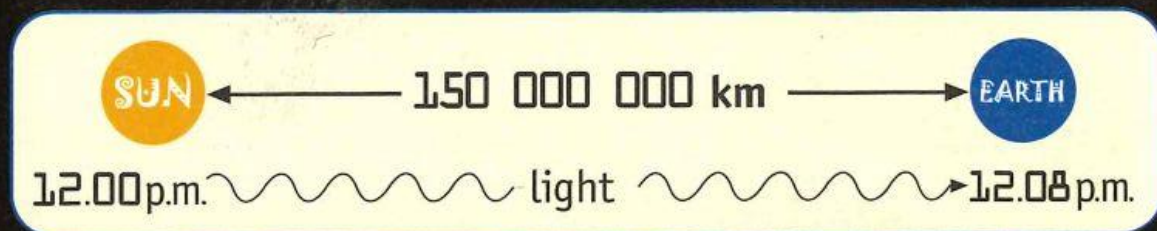
The Sun's diameter is 1.4 million kilometres, but the Earth has a diameter of only 12 756 kilometres. So the Sun is about 110 times wider than the Earth!



FACTS

The Sun is 150 million kilometres away from the Earth. If you could drive to the sun, travelling at 100 kilometres per hour, it would take 171 years to get there!

The Sun is so far away that its light takes eight minutes to get to us.



The next closest star to Earth is Alpha Centauri. Its light takes four and a half years to get to Earth. Think how old you will be in four and a half years. That's how old you will be when the light leaving Alpha Centauri today reaches your eye.

The ozone layer stops most of the UV radiation reaching us.

